- A snapshot lifecycle management (SLM) endpoint declared as `_slm` creates a policy that defines the snapshot along with its schedule and other attributes.
- We can initiate restoring data from a snapshot manually by invoking the `_restore` API.
- We can use Kibana's rich interface to define snapshots and policies and restore them. The policies are available under the Stack Management navigation menu.
- Elasticsearch exposes various settings via its elasticsearch.yml, jvm.options, and log4j2.properties files.
- We can tweak many attributes, such as changing the cluster name, moving the log and data path, adding network settings, and so on, by editing the elasticsearch.yml file.
- The config/jvm.options file defines JVM-related data for the node, but we must never edit this file.
- To customize the settings for JVM options, we need to create a new file ending with *.options (like custom_settings.options) and drop it in a folder called jvm.options.d, which should be present in the config folder for archived installations (tar or zip).
- We can set the required heap memory using the `-Xms` and `-Xmx` flags, where `-Xms` sets the maximum heap and `-Xmx` sets the minimum heap size. As a rule of thumb, never set heap size over 50% of available RAM.
- The master node in a cluster is a critical node that looks after managing and maintaining cluster-related operations and updating the distributed cluster state.
- The master node consults a quorum of nodes to commit the cluster state or elect a new master.
- A quorum is a minimum number of master-eligible nodes carefully selected by the cluster to alleviate node failures when making decisions.
- We should provide a minimum of three master-eligible nodes when forming a cluster, to avoid a split-brain cluster.